

The Open Database Alliance launched

Monty Program Ab, a MySQL database engineering company, and Percona, a MySQL services and support firm, have announced the 'The Open Database Alliance', a vendor-neutral consortium designed to become the industry hub for the MySQL open source database, including MySQL and derivative code, binaries, training, support, and other enhancements for the MySQL community



and partner ecosystem. The Open Database Alliance will comprise a collection of companies working together to provide the software, support and services for MariaDB, an enterprise-grade, community-developed branch of MySQL.

The intent of the Open Database Alliance is to unify all MySQL-related development and services, providing a solution to the fragmentation and uncertainty facing the communities, businesses and technical experts involved with MySQL. Still under development, the Open Database Alliance is open to all businesses, organisations and individuals interested in helping create a new, centralised resource for MySQL and to ensure that it remains a top quality, high performance open source database.

Monty Program Ab, founded by Monty Widenius, the 'father' of the MySQL database, and Percona, established by MySQL expert Peter Zaitsev, are the founding members of the Open Database Alliance. Monty Program is currently the primary developer of MariaDB, a branch of the MySQL database that includes all major open source storage engines, including the Maria transactional storage engine. "Our goal with the Open Database Alliance is to provide a central clearinghouse for MySQL development, to encourage a true open development environment with community participation, and to ensure that MySQL code remains extremely high quality," noted Monty. "Participating members at this stage in the 'Alliance' will have a strong voice in how the organisation is structured, and we look forward to collaborating with anyone in the industry that provides or depends on MySQL."

Oracle buys Virtual Iron

Oracle has agreed to acquire Virtual Iron Software (Virtual Iron), a provider of server virtualisation management software that enables dynamic resource and capacity management in virtualised data centres. The combination of Virtual Iron's technology and Oracle VM's scalable, high performance and highly available server virtualisation product is expected to provide more comprehensive and dynamic resource management across the full software stack. The company claims that customers are expected to benefit from better capacity utilisation, streamlined virtual server configuration, and improved visibility and control of their enterprise software. The transaction is subject to customary closing conditions and is expected to be concluded this summer. Until the deal closes, each company will continue to operate independently. Financial details of the transaction were not disclosed.



LinuxCon stated for Sept 21-23, 2009

The Linux Foundation (LF) has confirmed the dates for LinuxCon 2009. The event combines the developer and end user communities, resulting in more than 75 sessions that address "all matters Linux". The event will take place on September 21-23, 2009 in Portland, Oregon at the Marriott Downtown Waterfront.

LinuxCon represents both community and industry, fielding luminaries such as Mark Shuttleworth and industry experts such as IBM's Bob Sutor. Confirmed keynote speakers include:



Joe Brockmeier
Novell



Bdale Garbee
Hewlett Packard



Mark Shuttleworth
Canonical Ltd.



Bob Sutor
IBM

Joe "Zonker" Brockmeier, openSUSE community manager, Novell; Bdale Garbee, open source and Linux chief technologist at Hewlett Packard, well-known kernel developer; Mark Shuttleworth, founder of the Ubuntu distribution and Canonical; and Bob Sutor, vice president of Standards and Open Source at IBM.

Three tracks—developer, business and operations—will provide the foundation for sessions that include tutorials, keynotes, a technology showcase and targeted mini-summits on topics such as mobiles, the desktop, the embedded space, and much more. LinuxCon will be co-located with the annual Linux Plumbers Conference (LPC), which attracts a star-studded pool of technical talent. Registration is now open. Early Bird registration costs \$299 per person (until June 1, 2009), and Standard registration costs \$399 (until August 14, 2009).